

```
font-size:120%;  
}  
.spacer {  
clear:right;  
}
```

These approaches to floats merely skim the surface of possibilities, and by applying floats to things like dates, icons, and links, some very neat, space-saving effects can be achieved. Importantly, these basics will also form the crux of our approach to column layout.

8.5 Positioning

Positioning allows designers to place HTML elements with a greater accuracy using some simple CSS rules. The position property determines the reference point for the positioning of each element box. All boxes start out being positioned in the normal flow of elements in the document. CSS positioning is a difficult topic to grasp.

Let's begin by defining the four main types of positioning as quickly and simply as possible, before looking at each in more detail:

8.5.1 Static positioning

The easiest to understand, and closest to what you have already been doing in this book. This term basically describes how elements are placed by default. The browser takes your HTML and parses it into the individual elements, applying CSS to each as directed, and finally collating all of this into the visible web page. The final position an element takes as a result of this is its static position, and as such, it is nothing particularly special.

8.5.2 Absolute positioning

Absolute positioning allows you to dictate where the top-left corner, bottom-right corner, or other point of reference of an element will sit in relation to the nearest parent element that has been positioned out of the flow of the document. When the web page is scrolled, the elements retain their position against each other, and all scroll with the page as though glued together.

8.5.3 Fixed positioning

Fixed positioning allows an element to be placed in relation to the actual browser window. Therefore, if the page is scrolled, everything moves with it,